# Ashlyn Campbell

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## INTERESTS

AI in Education, Human-Centered Design, Human-Computer Interaction

## EDUCATION

**University of Michigan** 08/2025 — Present
Ph.D. in Information, Advisor: Dr. Patricia Garcia
*Affiliations*: Just Tech Lab, BIIT Lab

**Georgia State University**, **GPA: 4.05/4.00** 08/2021 — 05/2025
B.S. in Computer Science (Concentration in Data Science), Minor in Sociology

## PUBLICATIONS

*S = Under Submission, C = Conference, J = Journal (∗ = Equal Contribution)*

**[C.1] An Act of Hope: Black Women's Motivations to Enter a Socio-Academic Counterspace**
Ashlyn Campbell, Nannette Napier, Anu Bourgeois
*ACM Special Interest Group Computer Science Education (SIGCSE) 2027*

**[C.2] The Double Bind: Understanding Equity in the Context of Generative AI in Computing Education**
Ashlyn Campbell, Angela D.R. Smith
*ACM Research on Equity and Sustained Participation in Engineering, Computing, and Technology (RESPECT) 2026*

**[C.3] RISE Stars: An Experience Report on a Cohort of Black Freshmen Women in Computing**
Ashlyn Campbell, Anu Bourgeois, Nannette Napier
*ACM Special Interest Group Computer Science Education (SIGCSE) 2025*

## SELECTED RESEARCH PROJECTS

**User Research on Student-AI Interaction in Computing Learning Environments** 05/2026 – Present
*Collaborators:* Dr. Patricia Garcia, Dr. Yolanda Rankin, Dr. Mark Guzdial, Dr. Chelsea Peterson-Salahuddin

- Conducted an extensive literature review, Qualtrics survey, and semi-structured interviews to identify AI user needs, behaviors, pain points, and opportunities for improving learning experiences.
- Conducted thematic analysis on qualitative data (coded using Atlas.Ti) to communicate patterns in students' experiences.
- Translated research insights into actionable design considerations for researchers to improve generative AI systems.

**Assessment of Faculty Experiences with Active Learning Methods and Tools** 01/2026 – 06/2026
*Collaborators*: Dr. Barbara Ericson

- Conducted interviews with post-secondary faculty to understand their challenges adopting Peer Instruction.
- Collaborated with researchers to iteratively improve the user experience of the interactive textbook platform Runestone Academy used by 90,000+ students and 4,500+ teachers each year.

**Participatory Research with the NGO Boldly Moving Education Ahead (BMEA)** 01/2026 – 05/2026
*Collaborators:* Dr. April Baker-Bell, Dr. Curtis Lewis

- Conducted focus groups with the parents of students (aged 8-17) that participated in the BMEA Youth Leadership Development Program (YLDP) to understand the impact of initiatives.
- Worked alongside a collective of researchers to qualitatively code interviews and create analytic memos on initial findings.

## TEACHING

**Co-Instructor** – Thinking Critically About Large Language Models 06/2026 — 07/2026
*University of Michigan, School of Information – Summer Program*
→ Designed and led an interactive curriculum and workshop centered on critical AI literacy for high school students focused on the logic of large language models (LLMs) and beginner Python instruction.

**Co-Instructor** – She Won't Just Play the Game — She'll Build It 05/2026 — 07/2026
*Black Girls Code - Summer Program*
→ Taught 25 students aged 9-15 computer science concepts and game design fundamentals with Endless Studios.

**Undergraduate Teacher Assistant** – Software Engineering Capstone 09/2024 — 05/2025
*Georgia State University*
→ Managed grading for large computer science sections (+50 students).

**Undergraduate Teacher Assistant** – Introduction to Python Programming 2 09/2023 — 05/2024
*Georgia State University*

→ Managed grading and office hours sessions for large computer science sections (+200 students).

**Mathematics Student Assistant** – College Algebra 09/2021 — 05/2022
*Georgia State University*
→ Delivered 1:1 tutoring for recession courses (+300 students across disciplnes).

## LEADERSHIP POSITIONS

- **Advisory Board Member**, Alliance for Interdisciplinary Innovation in Computing Education 2025 — Present
- **Graduate Community Ambassador**, University of Michigan, Rackham PACE (MSI Connect) 2025 — Present
- **Program Assistant**, University of Michigan, Rackham PACE (Rackham Merit Fellowship) 2026
- **Co-Founder and Program Coordinator**, RISE in Computing Stars 2023 — 2025
  → Professional and technical development program impacting 75+ students in computer science.
- **Mentor**, IAMSTEM 2025
  → Led weekly sessions with high school students to share guidance on computer science.
- **Executive Board Member**, National Society of Black Engineers (NSBE) 2023 — 2024

## INTERNSHIP EXPERIENCE

**Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory - Data Science Summer Institute (DSSI)** 05/2025 — 08/2025
*Machine Learning Researcher*
Collaborators: Dr. Tsuyoshi A. Kohlgruber, Saurabh Narain
*Pattern Recognition using Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs)*
→ Skills Acquired: Data Preparation (+200k images and videos), and Visualization (using Python), Deep Learning Models

**Clemson University - Human and Technology (HAT) Lab** 01/2025 — 05/2025
*Undergraduate Research Experience (REU)*
Collaborators: Hansen Lee, Dr. Kelly Caine, Dr. Bart Knijnenburg
*Systematic Review of Human-Centered AI Research*
→ Skills Acquired: HCI Research Methods, Systematic Literature Reviews, Research Synthesis

**Microsoft - Bing@Work** 06/2024 — 09/2024
*Software Engineer*
Manager: Chandra Akkiraju
→ Collaborated across Copilot teams on the user interface design for Microsoft 365 applications to optimize compliant cloud-based application integration.

**Collins Aerospace - ISR & Space Solutions** 01/2023 — 08/2023
*Software Engineer*
Manager: Paul D. Miller
→ Improved field personnel efficiency and quality of procedures through automated scripting of software assessments.

**Georgia Community Action Association** 05/2022 — 01/2023
*Data Analyst*
Collaborators: Consuela Thompson, Walter Fordham
→ Improved the orgs understanding of outcomes by employing data-driven analyses to support evidence-based decision-making.

## AWARDS & ACHIEVEMENTS

1. Funded by the **National Science Foundation**, Graduate Research Fellow Program (NSF GRFP) 2026
   Awarded $159,000 (**1 in 2,500 selected**)
2. Selected by The National GEM Consortium Fellowship Program (GEM Fellowship) 2025
   Awarded $20,000
3. Funded by the University of Michigan, Rackham Graduate School Merit Fellowship (RMF) 2025
   Awarded +$200,000 **(1 out of 160 students)**
4. Received the Outstanding Computer Science Senior Award at Georgia State University 2025
5. Selected by the **Black in AI (BAI)** Emerging Leaders in AI Fellowship Program 2024
6. Granted the US Department of State Benjamin A. Gilman International Scholarship (Bali, Indonesia) 2023
   Awarded $5000
7. Granted the United Negro College Fund (UNCF) Sprout Social Scholarship 2023
   Awarded $5000

## INVITED TALKS

1. Speaker at the 2026 ACM Richard Tapia Conference on "Building Community for Graduate Applications" 2026
2. Panelist for the Duke University, 3C Fellows Convening University on "Student Voice in Action" 2026
3. Guest Speaker for University of Michigan, Wolverine Pathways "Year of Life-Changing Education" 2025

## SKILLS

- **UX Research Tools:** Figma, Qualtrics, Miro, Jira, Confluence, Microsoft Office (Excel, PowerPoint, Word)
- **Data & AI:** Python, R, SQL, Tableau, Alteryx, QGIS, Jupyter, OpenAI Codex, Microsoft Copilot, Google Gemini
- **Development:** Java, C/C++, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Git, Docker, Linux, Azure, Flask, Node.js, React Native